



BARSTOW COMMUNITY COLLEGE · FACULTY

Course materials reporting

Why the adoption form matters, what counts as a required material, and why zero cost does not mean no materials.

Angela Cardinale

Associate Dean, Library and Learning Support

September 1, 2026

THE LAW

This is a disclosure requirement, not a preference

Colleges must “prominently display ... the estimated costs for each course of all required course materials and fees directly related to those materials.”

Education Code § 66406.9, as amended by AB 607 (2023)

Federal law already asked for this. To the maximum extent practicable, the ISBN and retail price of required and recommended textbooks and supplemental materials belong on the course schedule used for registration.

THE DEADLINES ARE ESCALATING

Percentage of sections that must publish costs

40%

by Jan 1, 2025

55%

by Jan 1, 2026

65%

by Jan 1, 2027

75%

by Jan 1, 2028

The Chancellor's Office surveys colleges to certify compliance. The denominator is every section on the online schedule with an assigned instructor.

WHERE WE ARE

Building the picture, then getting it in front of students

We are collecting more accurate and more complete course materials information than we have before, and more sections are reporting each term.

The next step is publishing it on the class schedule, so the cost information reaches students at the point where it helps them, which is when they register. We are working on that now.

What we need from you is the first half: complete, detailed, timely entries for every section.

FALL 2026

THE MOST COMMON MISTAKE

Zero cost does not mean no materials

Common issues

- The book is free, so nothing gets reported
- “No required materials” chosen because nothing is purchased
- “This course uses OER” with no title, author, or link
- No ISBN and no edition, which leaves nothing to verify the price against
- Access codes, lab kits, and software left off
- Scanned chapters posted in Canvas in place of an adopted text, so nothing appears on the form at all

What the form needs

- An OER course **has** required materials. They are free, not absent.
- Every item listed separately, required ones marked required
- Title, author, edition, ISBN, and link
- Your best estimate of the cost. A price you do not know yet is not a reason to leave it blank. We verify with eCampus.
- Enough detail that a student could find and buy it from your entry alone

NOT ENOUGH Biology textbook, free online

ENOUGH **Biology 2e**, OpenStax 2nd ed., digital ISBN 9781947172524, openstax.org, \$0. Lab manual, \$18. Both required.

SCANNED READINGS

A scan is not an adoption

Posting scanned chapters in place of an adopted text creates three problems.

01

Copyright

Copying a chapter for your course usually needs permission or a license. Being educational does not make it automatic.

02

Accessibility

A scan is a picture of a page. A screen reader cannot read it aloud, and the text will not enlarge.

03

The report

The scan never reaches the adoption form, so the section looks like it has no materials.

Send the reading to the Library first. We can check licensing, request permission, buy an accessible copy, or find an open replacement.

THE XB12 CODES

Seven answers, and five of them are zero cost

CODE	WHAT IT MEANS	CATEGORY	SHARE OF FALL 2026
A	No required materials at all	ZERO COST	25%
C	Materials provided by the college	ZERO COST	3%
E	OER only	ZERO COST	20%
F	Free digital, not formally OER	ZERO COST	7%
G	Mix of OER and college-provided	ZERO COST	8%
D	Low cost, as defined locally. Ours is \$40 or less	LOW COST	8%
Y	Above our low cost line	STANDARD	29%

A AND E ARE NOT THE SAME ANSWER. CHOOSING A FOR AN OER COURSE LOSES THE OER COUNT.

ALL REQUIRED MATERIALS

It is not only the textbook

AB 607 requires disclosure of **all required course materials**, plus fees directly related to them. The Chancellor's Office names the first three specifically. The list is not closed.

01	02	03	04	05
Textbooks	Devices	Software subscriptions	Supplies	Related fees
Digital or physical.	Calculators, and remote attendance platforms.	Including access codes bundled with a text.	Lab kits, safety goggles, art materials, scrubs, tools, anything a student must buy.	Fees directly tied to those materials.

A free textbook paired with a \$60 access code is not a zero-cost course. If anything still costs money, the section is not ZTC.

ALSO ON YOU

Cost minimization is a stated duty

District policies “shall direct instructors to take reasonable steps to minimize the cost and ensure the necessity of instructional materials.”

Title 5, California Code of Regulations, § 59404(a)

Separately, a self-published textbook an instructor assigns to their own class is exempt from that act only if the instructor discloses the publishing and the use to the district. Royalties from materials containing your own work stay subject to the district’s conflict of interest policies and the collective bargaining agreement.

EDUCATION CODE § 66406.7, COLLEGE TEXTBOOK TRANSPARENCY ACT

ALREADY VETTED

Approved OER textbooks

The Curriculum Committee maintains a list of OER textbooks approved as appropriate representative textbooks. If something on the list fits your course, the vetting is already done.

You are not limited to the list. Faculty may choose their textbook, so long as it is course-appropriate.

THE LIST

barstow.edu/academics/library/oer-resources-faculty/approved-oers

Approved OERs, from the Library.

WHATEVER YOU ADOPT, IT STILL NEEDS REPORTING ON THE ADOPTION FORM

WHAT TO DO

Report every section, in full, on time

01

Every section

Including the ones with free materials and the ones with none.

02

Every item

Access codes, software, devices, lab supplies.

03

Your best estimate

Estimate the cost. We verify prices with eCampus.

04

Before registration

The disclosure only helps if it is there when students enroll.

QUESTIONS: LIBRARY@BARSTOW.EDU

COME WITH QUESTIONS

Training session

Wednesday, September 9

2:00 to 3:00 pm

with Kyri Freeman

A session on finding and adopting course materials, with a focus on open educational resources.

IN THE MEANTIME

barstow.edu/academics/library/ztcoer-resources-faculty

OER Resources for Faculty, from the Library.

BRING QUESTIONS ABOUT A COURSE YOU ARE WORKING ON